



Minnehaha United Methodist Church

A Reconciling Congregation

We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Rev. Jean Elliott, *Director of Children, Youth, & Their Families*;
Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes, *Band Leader*;
Cindy Bergstrom, *Choir Director*;
Nicholas Sabah & John Davis, *Communion Stewards*

Minnehaha United Methodist Church acknowledges that we gather on the traditional, ancestral, and contemporary land of Dakota People.

Attendance

We are delighted you are here! We invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically.

If you point your camera phone at the QR code, it will take you to a Google form where you can enter your information.



Offering

For our offering, you can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



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January 18, 2025 9:30 a.m.

* Please rise in body or spirit

Children in Worship

We always welcome children in worship! We assume that they may make noise, wiggle, and even run around. If you would like childcare during worship, we do have care for children ages 0-4 from 9:30-10:30 a.m. upstairs in the 2nd floor nursery. The worship service is live-streamed into the nursery. In addition, we have activity bags for children at the back of the sanctuary. Rocking chairs are also available for nursing or rocking at the back of the sanctuary and in the nursery.

Prelude

Anders Nelson, *organ*

Give Me Jesus

African-American spiritual, arr. Marques L.A. Garrett

A Little More Faith in Jesus

African-American spiritual, arr. John W. Work III

Welcome

*Call to Worship

(adapted from *Black Liturgies*, Cole Arthur Riley)

Leader: There is power in our breath.

People: **Power that comes from the breath of God's spirit within us.**

Leader: There is agency in our bodies.

People: **God, embodied in Jesus, reminds us that all flesh is sacred.**

Leader: Wherever we travel, wherever we stay, God is there.

People: **The same God who created the whole world is also present throughout the world.**

Leader: Let us worship this God of everything, everybody, everywhere.

People: **Let us worship.**

*Story and Hymn

The Faith We Sing (black)

Wade In the Water #2107

African American Spiritual; arr. © 1992 Carl Haywood

Children's Message

Rev. Jean Elliott

Baptism of Viviana Charlotte MacKenzie

Vows

Congregational Vow:

With God's help we will proclaim the good news and live according to the example of Christ. We will surround this child with a community of love and forgiveness, that she may grow in her service to others. We will pray for her, that she may be a true disciple who walks in the ways that lead to life.

Thanksgiving over the water

Baptism of Viviana Charlotte MacKenzie

Introduction

Congregational Response:

We welcome Viviana Charlotte joyfully and reverently as a member of our family, the family of God. We offer ourselves to be siblings, aunts and uncles, grandparents in Christ. We accept our sacred responsibility to help her grow in faith and in God's love. Send your blessing and your peace upon this family, that their love for one another and for you may grow. Help us to see your image in this child that we may also learn from her what life is about.

Sharing the Peace of Christ

Story of Service

Hazel Retherford, Siri Strom

Sharing of Joys and Concerns

Morning Prayer

(adapted from Black Liturgies, Cole Arthur Riley)

God of shalom, here we are dangling one another from the precipice without care or concern for our collective fate. We have lost sight of our own faces, risking our humanity in favor of supremacy. Guide us away from the edge of our undoing. Show us what it means to be people of deep and abiding reverence for the beauty and connectedness of everything everywhere. Train us out of habits of degradation and artifice – incessantly competing to be worth more, to be loved more. Remind us that we don't need to exalt humanity over any other piece of creation in order to be worth something. Keep us from the delusion of our dominion over earth, sky, or star. We are not greater. Remind us that the dust beneath us transcends our own humble existence, and let our hardened exteriors soften in the presence of safety. May any honor we've withheld from one another be doubled in the presence of reparation and forgiveness. We won't get free alone. Keep us human. Amen.

Silent Prayer

Pastoral Prayer

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

**Our Creator, God in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom* come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive
those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power
and the glory forever. *Amen.***

*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.

***Story and Hymn**

There Is a Balm in Gilead #375

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

African American Spiritual; adapt. and arr. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House

Story of Service

Calvin & Elias Emrick

Scripture Lesson

Amos 5:14-15, 24

*Story and Hymn

Precious Lord, Take My Hand #474

The United Methodist Hymnal (red) Thomas A. Dorsey © 1938, ren. Warner-Tamerlane Publ. Corp. (admin. Alfred Publishing Co., Inc.)

Story of Service

Nick Peterson

Offering of Gifts and Tithes

One of the pieces of music we are singing today is an African-American Spiritual. We pay no royalties for this music because its authorship has been lost to the history of racism. In lieu of a licensing fee, we invite you to make a contribution to our Spirituals Royalties Fund. For more information on the rationale behind this fund, look in the announcements section.

Offertory

Chancel Choir

I Want Jesus to Walk with Me

Spiritual, arr. Lloyd Larson

*Act of Praise

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Doxology #94

Thomas Ken (1674) Ralph Vaughan Williams (1906)

*Prayer of Dedication

Before your altar we offer to you, O God, what we have to give. Some of us have few financial resources, but we return a portion to accomplish your work through this church. You have promised that we shall not be lacking in any spiritual gift. These we bring for your blessing. May our offerings equip us to serve wherever you call. Amen.

Announcements

*Story and Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Lift Every Voice and Sing #519

James Weldon Johnson (1921) J. Rosamond Johnson (1921)

Benediction

Traveling Music

The Methodicals with Judi Bartlett, vocals

Singing In My Soul

Thomas A Dorsey; Unichappell Music Inc. (BMI)

In Our Prayers

Holding in prayer:

- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Jim Duncan (*Linda Duncan's husband*), Judy Durfey, George Gallagher (*Food Shelf Director*), Barb Spleiss

There will be a memorial service for **Carter Eichten** at the church on Friday, February 13 at 2:00. Visitation at 1:00.



All-Church Service Project Jan 18

Following the worship service, everyone is invited to assemble hygiene kits for UMCOR. In the narthex.

Annual Meeting Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held TODAY at 11:30. We'll have our 2025 Financial Report, our 2025 Membership Report and our 2026 Budget. Everyone is welcome to attend, and all members of the congregation can vote. We will

Sunday Youth Group from 4:00-5:30 pm

Today: Wear your winter gear and bring a sled!

We are looking for Scripture Readers

Children, Teens & Adults are encouraged & welcome to sign up!

Annette Meier will send the scripture to you on Wednesday - if you don't hear from her, or you sign up later than Wednesday, please text/call her (612) 597-1778 or e-mail at salmeier@hotmail.com. Here is the link to the sign-up tool:



THIS WEEK AT MINNEHAHA

Sunday Jan 18, 2026

- 9:30a Worship with Band (Sanctuary)
- 10:30a PUGA dance group (Gym)
- 10:45a MLK All Church Service Project (Narthex)
- 11:30a Annual Meeting (Fellowship Hall)
- 4p Youth Group (302/304)
- 5:30p Snow White Rehearsal (Fellowship Hall)
- 6p Rehearsal Mpls Choir Collective (Sanctuary)
- 7p SAA (306)

Monday Jan 19, 2026 Martin Luther King

- 1:30p Al-Anon (306)
- 6:30p Snow White Rehearsal (302/304)
- 6:30p Troop Meeting (Fellowship Hall & Gym)

Tuesday Jan 20, 2026

- 9a Fun & Fitness Group (302/304)
- 10a Food Shelf (Fellowship Hall, Narthex)
- 4p Organ practice (Sanctuary)
- 6p Karate Group (Gym)
- 6:30p Snow White Rehearsal (Fellowship Hall)
- 6:30p Youth Council (304)

Wednesday Jan 21, 2026

- 9:10a Men's Study of Scripture + Prophetic Consciousness (210)
- 5:30p Methodicals (Wesley Room & Sanctuary)
- 5:30p Wednesday Night Dinner (Fellowship Hall & Kitchen)
- 6p Wednesday Night Childcare (Gym, Nursery, Preschool rooms)
- 6:15p Chancel Choir (310)
- 6:15p Confirmation Class (302/304)

Thursday Jan 22, 2026

- 9a Fun & Fitness Group (302/304)
- 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup (202/204)
- 12p MinneHarvest Delivery
- 6p Karate Group (Gym)
- 6:30p Snow White Rehearsal (Fellowship Hall)
- 6:30p Trustees (Zoom)

Friday Jan 23, 2026

Winter Retreat

- 10a Al-Anon (306)
- 4p Organ practice (Sanctuary)
- 6:30p RCA (306)

Saturday Jan 24, 2026

Winter Retreat

- 7a MinneHarvest (Narthex, Outside)
- 9a M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School (Narthex, 206, 208, 302, 304, 306, 308, 310)
- 11a Karate Group (Gym)

Sunday Jan 25, 2026

Winter Retreat

- 9:30a Worship with Organ
- 10:45a Adult Faith Formation (310)
- 10:45a Sunday School (Classrooms)
- 11:30a Youth Choir Rehearsals (310)
- 3:30p PUGA dance group (Gym)
- 5:30p Snow White Rehearsal (Fellowship Hall)
- 6p Rehearsal Mpls Choir Collective (Sanctuary)
- 7p SAA (306)

Seeking Reflections on Light and Dark for Lenten Devotional Lent begins on Feb. 18, and we'd like to have a Lenten devotional to hand out on our theme this year – Light/Dark or Day/Night. We'll be following accounts in the Gospel of John where he cues us about the success of different things based on whether they happen in the light or in the dark, at the middle of the day or in the middle of the night. If you have a reflection or poem or picture or piece of music that you have written that you'd like included in our Lenten Devotional, please send it to Pastor Becky before Feb. 1 so we have time to assemble and distribute the devotionals.

2026's Recipient of Donations to MUMC's Spirituals Royalties Fund – Walker | West Music Academy

About MUMC's Spirituals Royalties Fund: We are aware that we pay royalties regularly for a wide variety of our music, but not for the spirituals we sing. While considered in the public domain, we are well aware that writers and composers of spirituals never had their names tied to their music, and that the communities originally fed by spirituals were denied a humane existence in our society. We cannot change or make up for the past, but we do want to be part of a future that forges a more equitable place for everyone. As a step toward that future, we collect special donations throughout the year for a Spirituals Royalties Fund that uplifts BIPOC voices. Past recipients we have supported through this fund: Capri Theater in Minneapolis (2022), Walker|West Music Academy in St. Paul (2023), Known MPLS (2024) and Vocal Essence WITNESS (2025).

Walker|West Music Academy: Walker|West Music Academy, located in the Rondo neighborhood of Saint Paul, is thought to be the oldest community music school founded by African Americans. It is a music learning community rooted in the African American cultural experience, where people of all ages and backgrounds gather to explore, perform, and grow through music." Rev. Carl Walker and Grant West started Walker|West Music Academy in 1988 answering the call to serve their community by bringing the healing power of music to their neighbors."

Just a reminder that our 2025 recipient, **Vocal Essence WITNESS** will have a concert at Northrop Auditorium on Sunday, Feb. 22 at 4:00 p.m. New arrangements of some of the spirituals done by B.E. Boykin is what our royalties fund helped support.



Narrowing the Gap: An Interactive Constructive Dialogue Workshop All are invited to a workshop on Saturday, Feb. 7 from 1-4 at Prospect Park UMC (22 Orlin Ave. SE). Participants will learn tools for deeper listening and effective ways to share their views, skills that are needed now in our families and communities. The workshop will be facilitated by Danger Boat productions.

the Minnehaha Players
proudly present

The Rockin' Tale of Snow White

Fri. Jan 30 at 7pm
Sat. Jan 31 & Sun. Feb 1 at 2 pm
and
Fri. Feb 6 & Sat. Feb 7 at 7pm
Sun. Feb 8 at 2pm

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street
Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org

Tickets: \$10 for adults,
\$6 for kids 12 & under,
\$25 family cap

Profits go to support UWF Missions for Women & Children-
Locally & Globally

Produced by special arrangement with
Pioneer Drama Service, Inc.,
Englewood, CO



MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month; join us on January 24 for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! You can volunteer anytime between 7:15 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up around 7:00, serve the food starting around 8:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30.

MINNEHARVEST
a food mission of minnehaha united methodist church